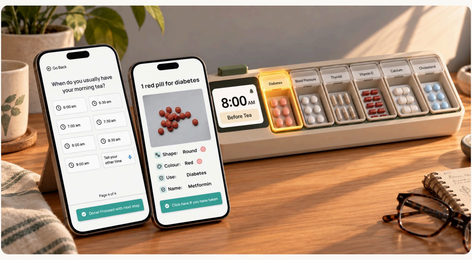
Simplifying Polypharmacy for Older Adults

Designing an accessible experience for managing multiple medications and everyday care.

My Role
Ux Research, Use interviews, Behavioural Research, Interaction design, Information architecture, Visual design.

Project Type
UX Research, Service design, application design.

Tools Used



What does the current scenario look like?

1 Managing around 4 to 12 medicines each day
Managing care can mean multiple medicines, frequent doctor visits, and changing prescriptions.

2 Medical Information Stored Separately
Medicine details and medical records are often scattered, making quick access difficult.

3 Multiple Doctor's visit and Prescription change
Frequent doctor visits lead to changing prescriptions and make care harder to manage.

4 Tedious Pill Arrangement
Sorting medicines into pill boxes by day and time is repetitive and time-consuming.

Qualitative Research

Interviewed 7elderly people, 9 family members, 1 medical student

"When my routine changes, I sometimes forget to take them, which affects my health."

"I remember my medicines through routines, like after brushing or before breakfast."

"I do not want to depend on my family all the time"

" Medical records are scattered"

"Sometimes we need a Caregiver, but it is hard to find them"

"I want to use digital tools, but they're often difficult to understand and use."

Quantitative Research

Surveyed 102 people

70%
"Still rely on memory"

65%
"Store medical records phscially"

52%
"See value in medicine remainders"

Secondary Research

Medicines are remembered by how they look
They often recognise medicines by their shape, size, colour or where they keep it.

Medicines are connected to routines
They often remember medicines as before tea, after lunch...

Remainders helpful when the medicines are new
Helpful until they get used to it

A digital solution needs to be genuinely useful
If their existing solution is working for them elready, they want something more from a digital solution

Elderly, wanted more features
Like medication schedules, reminders, dose tracking, refill alerts, and medicine information in one place.

Problem Statement

"How might we simplify medication and everyday care while keeping families involved?"

User personas

01 ELDERLY PERSON

Meena Joshi · 68
Retired teacher · Lives with her husband

Meena takes multiple medicines every day. She has developed her own way of remembering them through their appearance and her daily routine.

Needs
- Easily recognise the right medicine
- Store medical history and records
- Add medicines and records easily
- Get reminders when needed
- Adaptable remainder for routine change

Frustrations
- Similar-looking medicines get confusing
- Changing prescriptions disturb her routine
- Too many steps or information can feel overwhelming.

02 FAMILY CAREGIVER

Rahul Joshi · 39
Working professional · Meena's's son

Rahul helps manage her mothers healthcare, but work means he cannot always be around to check medicines, appointments or accompany her

Needs
- Know whether medicines are taken
- Quickly add or Update medicines
- Keep records and appointments together
- Find trustable caregiver
- Adaptable remainder for routine change

Frustrations
- Managing many medicines takes time
- Medical information is scattered
- Hard to know what happened when he wasn't there

The solution

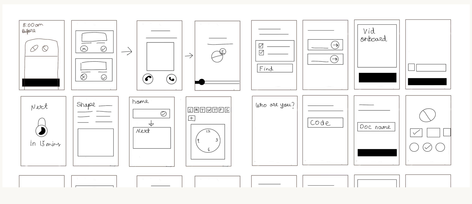
Grouped medicine system
Medicines taken around the same routine are grouped togeth

More personal routine remainders
Remainders can be set around smaller everyday routines like before tea, after tea...

Easy to recognise medicine remainders
Remainders that show the medicine's image, colour, shape and familiar name

Easy medicine management
Medicines can be added quickly, updated, or turned off when no longer needed

Family medicine tracking
Family members can see which medicines were taken or missed and keep track of the medicines

Book caregiver for specific needs
Families can find caregiver for specific needs and timeline

Wireframes